

From Rivalry to Friendship

There was a girl named Annie. Annie was a smart, kind, and curious girl. She was always at the top of her class, and she always tried her best in school, English, Math, Science, etc. she also liked helping other children.

Annie was not always smart, but she was also very kind, if someone had a nice drawing, Annie would say, "That looks beautiful". If someone passed a test, she would smile and say, "Well done". Annie believed that kind words could make people happy, and she wanted everyone at school to feel included.

But there was one boy at school who was the opposite of kind or friendly. His name was Kevin. Kevin was a mean boy who was always bullying other children at school. He laughed at them when they made mistakes all the time. He pushed in front of them in line to get what he wants. Sometimes, he takes their things and hides them. Kevin never apologizes, even when he knew he had done something wrong,

Everyone was scared of Kevin, but Annie tried not to be. She still hoped that maybe one day Kevin would change and become kinder.

One day, Kevin decided to pull a prank on Annie. He knew that Annie loved reading more than anything. She had one favorite book that she carried with her almost every day. It had a bright cover and exciting stories inside it. Annie read it during break time, after school, and sometimes even before class started.

Kevin thought, “I know what I can do. I will steal Annie’s favorite book and hide it. That’ll make her miserable”.

So, when Annie was not looking, Kevin took her favorite book from her desk and hid it in his bag. When Annie came back and saw that her book was gone, she searched everywhere.

“My book is missing!” Annie cried.

Then she saw Kevin smirking with a mischievous smile. Annie knew straight away that Kevin stole it. She felt so mad and furious. She couldn’t believe Kevin would do something so mean to her.

Annie wanted revenge. She thought about Kevin’s favorite action figure toy. He brought it to school almost everyday and showed it off to the other children. Annie thought, “Maybe I should steal his favorite toy. Then he will know how I felt”. At lunch time, Annie told her friends about her plan. But her friends were totally against it.

“No, Annie, you can’t do that”, one friend said.

“That won’t make you any better than him”, said another friend.

“If you do something mean back, then your rivalry with him won’t end”, her best friend explained.

Annie became quiet. She always listened to her friends because they cared about her. After thinking for a while, Annie sighed and said, “You’re right.”

Now Annie felt bad. She realized that revenge won’t fix anything. It would only make the problem worse. When she got home that afternoon, she sat at her desk and wrote a friendly letter to Kevin. She wrote about how she felt when he stole her book, but also wrote how she wants to forgive him.

The next day, Annie walked up to Kevin and gave him the letter. Kevin looked confused. He definitely thought Annie would take revenge on him.

In the letter, Annie wrote, “Kevin, I was very angry when you took my favorite book. I wanted to take your toy because I wanted revenge. But I am so sorry for thinking that. I do not want to be enemies. I want us to become friends.”

Kevin read the letter slowly. For the first time, he felt bad. He had expected Annie to be mean back to him, but instead she forgave him. Kevin looked down and said, “I’m sorry, Annie. I should not have taken your book.”

Then Kevin returned Annie's favorite book. "I promise I won't prank you or anyone else again", he said.

Annie smiled. Kevin slowly learned that the best revenge was forgiveness. After that, Annie and Kevin talked more. Kevin started being kinder to the other children, and Annie helped him get along with them in class.

From that day on, Annie and Kevin were no longer rivals. They became friends.

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